Chiral relations for entanglement in quantum self-phase modulation

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We investigate entanglement certification in the radial mode structure generated by self-phase modulation of a coherent beam carrying orbital angular momentum (OAM). We derive a chiral selection rule for the first-order anomalous correlations: at specified detection waists, the relative signs and magnitudes of the OAM values determine a finite set of radial partners for a reference mode. Nonzero coefficients certify pairwise entanglement and full inseparability of the selected set at sufficiently short propagation distances. Finite-distance calculations within the diffraction-free Bogoliubov approximation show that this first-order support continues to organize the certification pattern. Optimized covariance witnesses reveal entanglement involving modes outside that support, with smaller violation margins in the configurations investigated, and certify genuine multipartite entanglement in reduced sets of detection modes. These results identify radial–angular coupling as a means of controlling which spatial mode combinations admit entanglement certification.

I. INTRODUCTION

The quest for quantum devices based on optical resources is an intense and active field of research, which has already delivered important tools for quantum communication, computing and metrology. This quest has increased considerably by the possibility of shaping light in its different degrees of freedom, such as time envelope, spectral and spatial modes [1, 2]. Both discrete and continuous variable quantum information processing can benefit from these developments [3–5]. Nonlinear optical processes are the common tool for generating entangled quantum states, as it allows the energy transfer between different optical modes, constrained by different conditions such as energy conservation and phase matching, for example [6–10]. These conditions constrain the mode couplings through which quantum correlations and entanglement can develop [11–14]. Energy and momentum conservation are behind the generation of time-frequency and position-momentum entanglement, respectively. These conditions rule nonlinear optical processes such as three- and four-wave mixing, second harmonic generation and self-phase modulation [15–25].

Entanglement provides a resource for quantum communication protocols involving two or more parties [26]. In a spatially structured optical field, orthogonal modes provide distinct subsystems whose quadratures can be addressed by mode-selective detection. Controlling how a nonlinear interaction distributes entanglement among these modes is therefore a step toward preparing spatial resources for quantum information. This requires identifying both the modes involved and the form of entanglement that can be certified: correlations between pairs, entanglement across groups of modes, and genuine multipartite entanglement are different statements about the generated state [27].

The possibility of shaping the phase and polarization distributions with spatial light modulators and q-plates has become a powerful tool for controlled generation of customized entangled states both in linear and nonlinear optics. These developments brought the orbital angular momentum (OAM) of light to the toolbox of quantum information technology. Its role in nonlinear processes has also been unveiled by a plethora of scientific papers devoted to the constraints imposed by OAM and vortex formation in nonlinear wave mixing. In polariton superfluids, the interplay between phase, spin and flow gives rise to a rich variety of spatial structures, including quantized vortices, spin textures and vortex flows [28–32]. A recent work has further demonstrated the spectroscopy of collective excitations associated with stationary, multiply quantized vortices, opening new possibilities for exploring vortex dynamics in driven-dissipative quantum fluids of light [32].

A less exploited degree of freedom involves the radial structure of paraxial modes [8, 15, 16, 33–35]. The Laguerre-Gaussian (LG) solutions of the paraxial wave equation are the natural basis for describing OAM and the radial structure, which are the suitable labels for their identification. These modes are characterized by two integer numbers, namely its topological charge and radial index. The topological charge corresponds to the azimuthal variation of the beam phase around the propagation direction and the radial index determines the number of intensity rings. While the OAM conservation selection rule has been demonstrated in different quantum optical processes, the constraints related to the radial structure still deserves careful investigation.

Self-phase modulation is a particularly interesting phenomenon, where the intensity of an optical beam alters the effective refraction index of a nonlinear medium, thus affecting the beam's phase evolution along propagation through the medium [36]. This effect can also be observed in Bose-Einstein condensates and atomic vapors [37–39]. In a previous work we investigated the formation of a radial structure in self-phase modulation driven

by an OAM beam and determined the radial spectrum generated in terms of the topological charge of the input beam. This established an interesting radial-angular coupling promoted by the radial selection rules imposed on the nonlinear process [40].

In the present work we derive a radial–angular selection rule for entanglement certification in self-phase modulation. For a coherent LG pump and specified detection waists, the first-order anomalous correlations have finite radial support determined by the relative chirality of the interacting modes. Their nonzero coefficients guarantee two-mode entanglement at sufficiently short distances and establish full inseparability of the selected set. We then investigate finite propagation distances using the diffraction-free Bogoliubov approximation and optimized covariance witnesses. In the configurations studied, the first-order support continues to distinguish larger certification margins from the weaker violations involving additional radial modes.

Section II introduces the spatial mode operators and covariance matrix. Section III defines the parties, separability classes, and entanglement criteria used throughout the paper. Section IV derives the first-order correlations from the full fluctuation equation, and Sec. V establishes their chiral selection rule and its consequences for certification. Section VI examines the finite-distance behavior and genuine multipartite entanglement of reduced sets of detection modes.

II. SPATIALLY STRUCTURED BOSONIC FIELD

We first introduce the spatial mode operators and correlations used to describe the field. This formulation identifies the optical subsystems and provides the covariance matrix on which the entanglement criteria of Sec. III act.

We start by considering the normalized positive frequency component of the quantized electromagnetic field $\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r})$ satisfying the commutation relations

$$\begin{aligned}\left[\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_1),\mathcal{E}^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2)\right] &= \delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1-\mathbf{r}_2),\\ \left[\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_1),\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_2)\right] &= \left[\mathcal{E}^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_1),\mathcal{E}^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2)\right] = 0.\end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

In the above equation and in what follows, $\mathbf{r} = (x, y)$ is the transverse coordinate. One can introduce ladder operators $a(v), a^\dagger(v)$ associated with the spatial mode v by the expression

$$a(v) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^2} v^*(\mathbf{r})\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r})d\mathbf{r}. \tag{2}$$

We then have

$$\begin{aligned}\left[a(v_1),a^\dagger(v_2)\right] &= (v_1;v_2) \equiv \int_{\mathbb{R}^2} v_1^*(\mathbf{r})v_2(\mathbf{r})d\mathbf{r}\,,\\ \left[a(v_1),a(v_2)\right] &= \left[a^\dagger(v_1),a^\dagger(v_2)\right] = 0\,.\end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

For orthonormal profiles, $(v_j; v_k) = \delta_{jk}$, these are independent bosonic mode operators. Each mode has its own Fock space, and a set of such modes defines a tensor product of subsystems. Orthogonality does not require spatially separated intensity profiles: distinct modes can overlap within the same beam. The operator construction also applies to nonorthogonal or unnormalized detection functions, but these do not by themselves define independent parties for an entanglement test. All mode parties considered below are defined by orthonormal profiles.

Given a classical field distribution $\alpha(\mathbf{r})$ normalized in such a way that $|\alpha(\mathbf{r})|^2$ represents the photon number per unit area, we may build a coherent state through the expression

$$|\alpha\rangle = \exp\left[a^\dagger(\alpha) - a(\alpha)\right]|0\rangle\,, \tag{4}$$

where $|0\rangle$ is the vacuum state. This state is an eigenvector of the field operator,

$$\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r})\,|\alpha\rangle = \alpha(\mathbf{r})\,|\alpha\rangle\,. \tag{5}$$

This is the type of state that will be used as input on the nonlinear medium.

The field quadratures are defined by

$$X(v) = \frac{a(v) + a^\dagger(v)}{\sqrt{2}}\,. \tag{6}$$

Here, v is the corresponding field mode. The complementary quadrature is simply defined by shifting v by a $\pi/2$ phase: $P(v) = X(iv)$.

The covariance function is given by

$$\Gamma(v_1, v_2) = \langle\{\Delta X(v_1), \Delta X(v_2)\}\rangle\,, \tag{7}$$

where $\Delta X(v) = X(v) - \langle X(v)\rangle$ and $\{\bullet,\bullet\}$ denotes the anticommutator. The calculation of this observable is simplified if we express it in terms of the field $\mathcal{E}$. For this, we introduce the normal and anomalous correlations, given respectively by

$$H(\mathbf{r}_1,\mathbf{r}_2) = \left\langle\mathcal{E}^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2)\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_1)\right\rangle - \left\langle\mathcal{E}^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2)\right\rangle\langle\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_1)\rangle\,, \tag{8}$$

$$F(\mathbf{r}_1,\mathbf{r}_2) = \langle\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_1,z)\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_2,z)\rangle - \langle\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_1)\rangle\langle\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}_2)\rangle\,. \tag{9}$$

We may then write

$$\Gamma(v_1,v_2) = \mathrm{Re}\left[(v_1;v_2) + 2f(v_1,v_2) + 2h(v_1,v_2)\right], \tag{10}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned}h(v_1,v_2) &= \int v_1^*(\mathbf{r}_1)v_2(\mathbf{r}_2)H(\mathbf{r}_1,\mathbf{r}_2)\,d\mathbf{r}_1\,d\mathbf{r}_2\\ &= \left\langle a^\dagger(v_2)a(v_1)\right\rangle - \left\langle a(v_2)\right\rangle^*\langle a(v_1)\rangle\end{aligned} \tag{11}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned}f(v_1,v_2) &= \int v_1^*(\mathbf{r}_2)v_2^*(\mathbf{r}_1)F(\mathbf{r}_1,\mathbf{r}_2)\,d\mathbf{r}_1\,d\mathbf{r}_2\\ &= \langle a(v_1)a(v_2)\rangle - \langle a(v_1)\rangle\langle a(v_2)\rangle\end{aligned} \tag{12}$$

We further note the following properties, which simplify the consideration of linear combination of modes:

$$\begin{aligned} f(v_1, v_2 + \lambda v_3) &= f(v_1, v_2) + \lambda^* f(v_1, v_3) \\ f(v_1, v_2) &= f(v_2, v_1) \\ h(v_1, v_2 + \lambda v_3) &= h(v_1, v_2) + \lambda h(v_1, v_3) \\ h(v_1, v_2) &= h(v_2, v_1)^* \end{aligned} \tag{13}$$

These are a reflection of the fact that $a(v)$ is antilinear while $a^\dagger(v)$ is linear.

For N orthonormal modes, define the quadrature vector and covariance matrix by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Z} &= \big(X(v_1), P(v_1), \ldots, X(v_N), P(v_N)\big), \\ \gamma_{jk} &= \langle \{\Delta Z_j, \Delta Z_k\} \rangle \, . \end{aligned} \tag{14}$$

Every entry follows from Eq. (10), using $P(v) = X(iv)$. With our normalization, $[X(v_j), P(v_k)] = i\delta_{jk}$, the vacuum variance of each quadrature is $1/2$, and the vacuum covariance matrix is $\mathbb{1}_{2N}$. We express quadrature variances in shot-noise units (SNU), defining $V_{\mathrm{SNU}}(Q) = 2\left\langle (\Delta Q)^2 \right\rangle$, so that vacuum noise is one in these units.

A. Single-mode squeezing

For a single normalized mode v, the eigenvalues of the 2×2 covariance matrix are its principal quadrature variances in SNU. Since $h(v, v) \in \mathbb{R}$, Eq. (10) gives

$$\gamma = (1 + 2h(v, v))\, \mathbb{1}_2 + 2 \operatorname{Re} f(v, v) \sigma_z + 2 \operatorname{Im} f(v, v) \sigma_x \, , \tag{15}$$

where $\mathbb{1}_2$ is the 2×2 identity, and σ_x and σ_z are the corresponding Pauli matrices. Notice that $f(e^{i\phi} v, e^{i\phi} v) = e^{-i2\phi} f(v, v)$. Therefore, we can diagonalize γ by choosing $\phi = [\arg f(v, v) \pm \pi]/2$ and obtain the eigenvalues

$$\lambda_\pm = 1 + 2\left[\, h(v, v) \pm |f(v, v)| \,\right] . \tag{16}$$

We then see that the quadrature rotated by ϕ has minimum variance λ_- in SNU, while the one rotated by $\phi + \pi/2$ has maximum variance λ_+. Furthermore, we have squeezing if $|f(v, v)| > h(v, v)$.

III. ENTANGLEMENT AND COVARIANCE-BASED CERTIFICATION

A. Parties and separability

We take the parties to be specified orthogonal modes or disjoint groups of modes. Radial and OAM indices label the spatial profiles; the quantum subsystems are their associated Fock spaces. A bipartition $S|T$ divides the parties into two nonempty groups. A state is separable across that cut if it admits a decomposition

$$\rho_{S|T} = \sum_\lambda p_\lambda \rho_S^{(\lambda)} \otimes \rho_T^{(\lambda)}, \qquad p_\lambda \geq 0, \quad \sum_\lambda p_\lambda = 1. \tag{17}$$

Otherwise it is entangled across $S|T$. Full separability requires a convex mixture of products over all individual parties. Pairwise entanglement refers to the reduced state of two parties after the others have been traced out. Entanglement across a multimode cut can be present even when pairwise tests do not detect it.

A state is fully inseparable if it is entangled across every nontrivial bipartition of the specified parties. For mixed states, this does not exclude a biseparable decomposition

$$\rho_{\mathrm{bisep}} = \sum_\lambda p_\lambda \rho_{S_\lambda | T_\lambda} \, , \tag{18}$$

where each component is separable as in Eq. (17), but the cut may vary with λ. Genuine multipartite entanglement (GME) excludes all such decompositions [27]. Physically, GME rules out preparing the state by randomly choosing which subgroups share entanglement. Full inseparability and GME coincide for pure states; they are distinct requirements for mixed states.

B. Covariance based entanglement witnesses

The correlations introduced in Sec. II allow entanglement to be certified from quadrature measurements. Following Hyllus and Eisert [41], a covariance witness for a specified separability class is a real, symmetric, positive semidefinite matrix $\mathcal{Z}$ satisfying

$$\operatorname{Tr}(\mathcal{Z} \gamma_{\mathrm{sep}}) \geq 1 \tag{19}$$

for every covariance matrix of a state in that class. Consequently,

$$\operatorname{Tr}(\mathcal{Z} \gamma) < 1 \tag{20}$$

excludes that class for any state with covariance matrix γ. Choosing the class of states separable across a fixed cut tests entanglement across that cut; choosing the entire biseparable class tests GME. A value at or above one is inconclusive. The margin below one measures the violation of the chosen criterion and is not, by itself, an entanglement measure.

C. Two-mode Duan criterion

For two orthonormal modes v_1, v_2, the Duan criterion [42] certifies entanglement of their reduced state when

$$\begin{aligned} D = \frac{1}{2} \left\langle \left[\Delta X(v_1) + \Delta X(v_2)\right]^2 \right\rangle \\ + \frac{1}{2} \left\langle \left[\Delta P(v_1) - \Delta P(v_2)\right]^2 \right\rangle < 1. \end{aligned} \tag{21}$$

In the quadrature ordering of Eq. (14), this is $D = \mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{Z}_D\gamma)$ with

$$\mathcal{Z}_D = \frac{1}{4}\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{22}$$

Equation (10) gives the useful expression

$$D = 1 + h(v_1, v_1) + h(v_2, v_2) + 2\,\mathrm{Re}\, f(v_1, v_2). \tag{23}$$

A phase rotation $v_1 \mapsto e^{i\phi}v_1$, with $\phi = \arg f(v_1, v_2) \pm \pi$, minimizes this quantity:

$$D_{\mathrm{opt}} = 1 + h(v_1, v_1) + h(v_2, v_2) - 2|f(v_1, v_2)|. \tag{24}$$

This optimization changes only the quadrature phases. It does not optimize over all covariance witnesses. Its simple dependence on the anomalous correlation makes it particularly suitable for deriving the short-distance selection rule below.

D. Multimode certification and optimized witnesses

Pairwise tests also constrain multimode separability: an entangled pair crossing a cut excludes separability across that cut, since tracing out other modes preserves separability. A collection of pairwise violations that crosses every bipartition therefore establishes full inseparability. This reasoning underlies the pairwise version of the criteria discussed by van Loock and Furusawa [26]; we use it below for a reference mode coupled to several radial partners. For mixed states, the additional exclusion of Eq. (18) is needed to establish GME [27].

The van Loock–Furusawa criteria also allow quadratures of additional modes to enter with adjustable gains [26]. These collective observables can reveal entanglement across cuts when the reduced pairs fail the Duan test. More generally, Hyllus and Eisert optimize over covariance witnesses using semidefinite programming [41]. For the same separability class, optimization over a larger witness family can detect correlations missed by a restricted quadrature criterion.

We use two such optimizations. For each specified bipartition, the FullyWit routine minimizes $\mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{Z}\gamma)$ over witnesses valid for that cut. Violations for every cut establish full inseparability. The MultiWit routine instead imposes validity for all biseparable states, so a violation certifies GME of the selected parties. Both use the covariance matrix of the selected modes after the remaining field has been traced out. These established criteria provide the framework for interpreting the radial–angular coupling derived next.

IV. KERR DYNAMICS AND FIRST-ORDER CORRELATIONS

We consider a monochromatic field propagating through a $\chi^{(3)}$ nonlinear medium, with a coherent spatial mode as input. The nonlinear interaction produces both a change in the mean field and correlations between mode fluctuations. We now calculate these correlations to first order in propagation distance and apply the criteria of Sec. III.

We will assume that the field is propagating along the z direction, and satisfies the Heisenberg equation of motion

$$2ik\partial_z\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}, z) + \nabla^2\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}, z) = g\,\mathcal{E}^\dagger(\mathbf{r}, z)\mathcal{E}^2(\mathbf{r}, z)\,, \tag{25}$$

where g is the Kerr nonlinear coupling constant and ∇^2 denotes the transverse Laplacian. The short-distance expansion below retains the full fluctuation equation and yields the exact coefficient linear in distance. In Sec. VI, we adopt a different approximation: diffraction-free, linearized fluctuation dynamics with the full distance dependence retained. This allows us to investigate how the first-order certification pattern extends to finite propagation distances.

To start our derivation, let $\alpha_c(\mathbf{r}, z)$ denote the solution of the classical equations of motion

$$2ik\partial_z\alpha_c + \nabla^2\alpha_c = g\,|\alpha_c|^2\alpha_c \tag{26}$$

under the initial condition $\alpha_c(\mathbf{r}, 0) = \alpha(\mathbf{r})$, where $|\alpha\rangle$ is the input coherent state. Let us also define the fluctuation field

$$\eta(\mathbf{r}, z) = \mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r}, z) - \alpha_c(\mathbf{r}, z) \tag{27}$$

We observe that our initial state has vacuum like properties with respect to $\eta(\mathbf{r}, 0)$. For example, it is annihilated by it:

$$\eta(\mathbf{r}, 0)\,|\alpha\rangle = 0 \tag{28}$$

Furthermore, any normally ordered monomial containing at least one fluctuation operator has zero expectation value at $z = 0$.

The correlation functions, which are our observables of interest, can also be compactly written in terms of η:

$$\begin{aligned} F(\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2; z) &= \langle\eta(\mathbf{r}_1, z)\eta(\mathbf{r}_2, z)\rangle - \langle\eta(\mathbf{r}_1, z)\rangle\langle\eta(\mathbf{r}_2, z)\rangle, \\ H(\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2; z) &= \langle\eta^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2, z)\eta(\mathbf{r}_1, z)\rangle - \langle\eta(\mathbf{r}_1, z)\rangle\langle\eta^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2, z)\rangle. \end{aligned} \tag{29}$$

Next, we write the equation of motion

$$2ik\partial_z\eta + \nabla^2\eta = g\left(2|\alpha_c|^2\eta + \alpha_c^2\eta^\dagger + \Omega\right) \tag{30}$$

where the nonlinear fluctuation terms are

$$\Omega = \alpha_c^*\eta^2 + 2\alpha_c\eta^\dagger\eta + \eta^\dagger\eta^2. \tag{31}$$

We start by considering an approximation where only terms up to $\mathcal{O}(z)$ are retained. From definition, we already have $\langle\eta(\mathbf{r}, 0)\rangle = 0$. Furthermore, as the equation

of motion (30) contains only normally ordered terms, we also get $\partial_z \langle \eta(\mathbf{r},0)\rangle = 0$, such that

$$\langle \eta(\mathbf{r},z)\rangle = \mathcal{O}(z^2), \tag{32}$$

or, equivalently,

$$\langle \mathcal{E}(\mathbf{r},z)\rangle = \alpha_c(\mathbf{r},z) + \mathcal{O}(z^2). \tag{33}$$

Now we turn to the correlation functions. For compactness, we write $\eta_{j,z} = \eta(\mathbf{r}_j, z)$. In order to calculate the normal correlation, we differentiate the two-operator average:

$$\partial_z \langle \eta_2^\dagger \eta_1\rangle\Big|_0 = \langle (\partial_z \eta_2^\dagger)_0 \eta_{0,1}\rangle + \langle \eta_{0,2}^\dagger (\partial_z \eta_1)_0\rangle. \tag{34}$$

Both terms vanish: the first average has an annihilation operator on the right, and the second has its conjugate on the left.

Turning, to the anomalous case, we have that

$$\begin{aligned}\partial_z \langle \eta_{1,z}\eta_{2,z}\rangle|_0 &= \langle (\partial_z\eta_1)_0\eta_{2,0}\rangle + \langle \eta_{1,0}(\partial_z\eta_2)_0\rangle \\ &= \langle \eta_{1,0}(\partial_z\eta_2)_0\rangle.\end{aligned} \tag{35}$$

Isolating $\partial_z \eta$ in the equations of motion (30) and substituting above, we see that almost all the terms are zero, because they contain η to the right. The only exception is the term proportional to $\eta^\dagger$, which gives

$$\partial_z \langle \eta_1\eta_2\rangle|_0 = -\frac{ig}{2k}\alpha^2(\mathbf{r}_2)\delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2). \tag{36}$$

Since the mean-subtraction terms do not contribute at first order, the correlations are

$$\begin{aligned}F(\mathbf{r}_1,\mathbf{r}_2;z) &= -\frac{igz}{2k}\alpha^2(\mathbf{r}_2)\delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1-\mathbf{r}_2) + \mathcal{O}(z^2),\\ H(\mathbf{r}_1,\mathbf{r}_2;z) &= \mathcal{O}(z^2).\end{aligned} \tag{37}$$

Using the spatial overlap notation

$$(v_1,\ldots,v_n;u_1,\ldots,u_n) = \int d^2\mathbf{r}\,\prod_{j=1}^n v_j^*(\mathbf{r})u_j(\mathbf{r}), \tag{38}$$

projection onto the modes v_1 and v_2 gives

$$\begin{aligned}f(v_1,v_2) &= -\frac{igz}{2k}(v_1,v_2;\alpha,\alpha) + \mathcal{O}(z^2),\\ h(v_1,v_2) &= \mathcal{O}(z^2).\end{aligned} \tag{39}$$

To specify the input and introduce a natural transverse scale, we consider coherent Laguerre-Gaussian modes, with

$$\alpha(\mathbf{r}) = \|\alpha\|\, LG_{pl}(\mathbf{r};w), \tag{40}$$

where the waist-plane modes are

$$\begin{aligned}LG_{pl}(\mathbf{r};w) = \frac{(-1)^p\mathcal{N}_{pl}}{w}\left(\frac{2r^2}{w^2}\right)^{|l|/2} \\ \times L_p^{|l|}\left(\frac{2r^2}{w^2}\right)e^{-r^2/w^2 + il\phi},\end{aligned} \tag{41}$$

with radial order p, topological charge l, and normalization constant

$$\mathcal{N}_{pl} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{\pi}}\sqrt{\frac{p!}{(p+|l|)!}}\,. \tag{42}$$

The waist w sets the natural transverse scale. Let us define the Rayleigh range $z_R = kw^2/2$, the nonlinear interaction length $z_{NL} = 4z_R/(g\|\alpha\|^2)$, the dimensionless propagation distance $Z = z/z_{NL} = gz\|\alpha\|^2/(2kw^2)$, and the dimensionless input profile $u(\mathbf{r}) = w\alpha(\mathbf{r},0)/\|\alpha\|$.

Using these definitions, Eq. (10) and the squeezing and Duan criteria give the first-order results

$$\begin{aligned}f(v_1,v_2) &\approx -iZ(v_1,v_2;u,u),\\ \Gamma(v_1,v_2) &= \mathrm{Re}(v_1;v_2) + 2Z\,\mathrm{Im}(v_1,v_2;u,u) + \mathcal{O}(Z^2),\\ \lambda_- &= 1 - 2\,|Z(v,v;u,u)| + \mathcal{O}(Z^2),\\ D_{\mathrm{opt}} &= 1 - 2\,|Z(v_1,v_2;u,u)| + \mathcal{O}(Z^2).\end{aligned} \tag{43}$$

For an input angular momentum l_0, the angular integration requires $l_v = l_0$ for a linear squeezing contribution and $l_{v_1} + l_{v_2} = 2l_0$ for a linear Duan violation. These OAM conditions are necessary for first-order certification; the corresponding radial overlap must also be nonzero.

V. CHIRAL SELECTION RULE AND ENTANGLEMENT CERTIFICATION

We now specialize to the LG input $\alpha(\mathbf{r}) = \|\alpha\|\, LG_{0,l_0}(\mathbf{r};w)$ and analyze the selection rules for radial and angular mode coupling.

Our previous work [40] has shown that, in the classical regime, the first order treatment gives a selection rule for the generation of radial orders up to $|l_0|$. The current quantum treatment clarifies that this was, in fact, a selection rule for the mean field value $\langle\mathcal{E}\rangle$ given by (33), whose expression had already appeared on our earlier treatment.

We now derive the radial selection rule for the first-order anomalous correlations and use it to establish pairwise and multimode entanglement at sufficiently small nonzero distances. All detection profiles and their waists are held fixed in this expansion.

A. Radial selection rules and two-mode entanglement

Let $v_2 = LG_{0,l_2}(\mathbf{r};w_2)$ where w_2 is free and l_2 is only constrained by $l_2 \neq l_0$. Now, define $l_1 = 2l_0 - l_2$ and

$1/w_1^2 = 2/w^2 + 1/w_2^2$. We then have that

$$v_2^*(\mathbf{r})u^2(\mathbf{r}) = \frac{\mathcal{N}_{0l_2}\mathcal{N}_{0l_0}^2}{w_2}\left(\frac{2r^2}{w_2^2}\right)^{\frac{|l_2|}{2}}\left(\frac{2r^2}{w^2}\right)^{|l_0|} e^{-\frac{r^2}{w_1^2}+il_1\phi}$$
$$= \frac{\mathcal{N}_{0l_2}\mathcal{N}_{0l_0}^2\, w_1^{2|l_0|+|l_2|}}{w_2^{|l_2|+1}w^{2|l_0|}}\left(\frac{2r^2}{w_1^2}\right)^{\frac{|l_1|}{2}}\left(\frac{2r^2}{w_1^2}\right)^{p_{\max}}$$
$$\times\, e^{-\frac{r^2}{w_1^2}+il_1\phi}, \tag{44}$$

where we have defined

$$p_{\max} = |l_0| + \frac{|l_2| - |2l_0 - l_2|}{2}$$
$$= \begin{cases} 0, & l_0 l_2 \le 0 \\ \min(2|l_0|, |l_2|), & l_0 l_2 > 0 \end{cases}. \tag{45}$$

Then, by expanding the monomial that is raised to the power of $p_{\max}$ in terms of Laguerre polynomials, we get

$$v_2^*(\mathbf{r})u^2(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{p=0}^{p_{\max}} C_p\, LG_{pl_1}(\mathbf{r}; w_1)\,, \tag{46}$$

where

$$C_p = \frac{p_{\max}!\mathcal{N}_{0l_2}\mathcal{N}_{0l_0}^2\, w_1^{2|l_0|+|l_2|+1}}{\mathcal{N}_{pl_1} w_2^{|l_2|+1} w^{2|l_0|}}\binom{p_{\max}+|l_1|}{p_{\max}-p}. \tag{47}$$

Therefore, setting $v_1 = LG_{pl_1}(\mathbf{r}; w_1)$, which is orthogonal to v_2, and considering the two mode subsystem formed by v_1, v_2, we get an optimal Duan violation of

$$D_{\text{opt}} = \begin{cases} 1 - 2C_p|Z| + \mathcal{O}(Z^2), & p \le p_{\max} \\ 1 + \mathcal{O}(Z^2), & p > p_{\max} \end{cases}. \tag{48}$$

For $0 \le p \le p_{\max}$, the coefficients C_p are positive with the chosen LG phase convention. Their linear contribution therefore dominates the $\mathcal{O}(Z^2)$ remainder for sufficiently small nonzero Z, establishing entanglement of each corresponding pair. For $p > p_{\max}$, only the linear coefficient vanishes: Eq. (48) does not decide whether higher-order correlations produce entanglement. The finite radial support is a property of this first-order coefficient in the specified waist basis.

B. Consequences for multipartite certification

Let $\mathcal{A}$ denote the reference mode v_2, and let $\mathcal{B}_p$ denote $LG_{p,l_1}(w_1)$ for $p = 0, \ldots, p_{\max}$. These are mutually orthonormal mode parties. Since their number is finite, Eq. (48) gives a common small-distance interval in which every reduced pair $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{B}_p$ is entangled. Every nontrivial bipartition of the selected set separates $\mathcal{A}$ from at least one partner. The crossing-pair criterion of Sec. III D therefore establishes full inseparability of this set. This applies to its generally mixed reduced state and does not, by itself, certify GME.

For the ideal closed, lossless model, purity of the complete field gives a further consequence. Denote the remaining field modes by $\mathcal{R}$. For $p_{\max} \ge 1$, the grouping

$$\mathcal{A} \mid \mathcal{B}_0 \mid \cdots \mid \mathcal{B}_{p_{\max}-1} \mid (\mathcal{B}_{p_{\max}}\mathcal{R}) \tag{49}$$

includes all degrees of freedom and is pure. The same pairs cross every bipartition, so these $p_{\max}+2$ grouped parties are genuinely multipartite entangled. For $p_{\max} = 0$, the statement reduces to bipartite entanglement across $\mathcal{A}|(\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{R})$. This party count is a guaranteed grouping at the specified detection waists, not an upper bound on the number of entangled field modes. It also does not establish GME of the selected single modes after $\mathcal{R}$ is discarded.

We next ask how the certification pattern changes at finite distance and whether GME can be certified directly in the reduced selected state.

VI. ENTANGLEMENT AT FINITE PROPAGATION DISTANCES

A. Diffraction-free Bogoliubov solution

The first-order expressions describe the initial generation of correlations, but extrapolating them to larger distances can give negative values of λ_- or D_{opt}. For finite-distance predictions, we return to the full equation for the same decomposition $\mathcal{E} = \alpha_c + \eta$ and adopt a different approximation: we neglect diffraction and discard the nonlinear fluctuation terms Ω in Eq. (30), while retaining the full dependence on propagation distance. This linearization of the fluctuation dynamics is the Bogoliubov approximation, used to describe quantum fluctuations in paraxial propagation through Kerr media [43]. Appendix A solves the diffraction-free Bogoliubov equations without a Taylor expansion in distance. The dimensionless classical field is then

$$u_Z(\mathbf{r}) = u(\mathbf{r})e^{-iZ|u(\mathbf{r})|^2}, \tag{50}$$

and the mode correlations are

$$f(v_1, v_2) = -iZ(v_1, v_2; u_Z, u_Z)$$
$$- Z^2(v_1, v_2, u_Z; u_Z, u_Z, u_Z),$$
$$h(v_1, v_2) = Z^2(v_1, u_Z, u_Z; v_2, u_Z, u_Z). \tag{51}$$

These expressions agree with the preceding first-order result and are exact within the diffraction-free linearized fluctuation equations. Their use at finite distance requires negligible diffraction over the interaction region, which is a reasonable approximation for softly focused beams, as well as a small fluctuation backreaction. The numerical results below use these correlations under those assumptions.

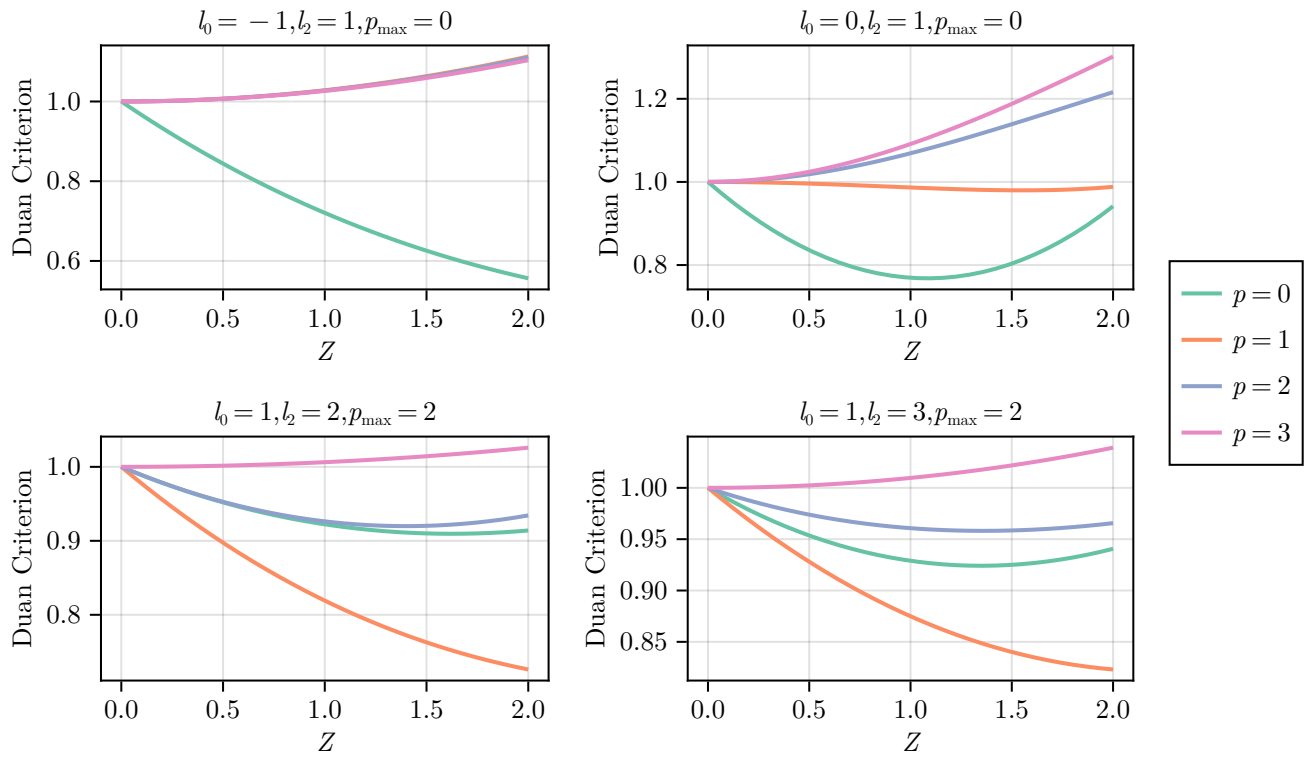


FIG. 1. Phase-optimized Duan quantity for the diffraction-free Bogoliubov solution. Values below one certify two-mode entanglement.

B. Two-mode certification

Figure 1 compares the phase-optimized Duan quantity for several combinations of l_0 and l_2. The modes within the first-order support show the larger violations in these examples, while those outside it remain close to or above the separability threshold. In particular, for $l_0 = 0$ and $l_2 = 1$, the $p = 1$ curve exhibits a small violation even though $p_{\max} = 0$. The finite-distance results therefore retain a distinction in certification margins while allowing violations beyond the first-order cutoff.

We next apply the fixed-cut covariance optimization introduced in Sec. III D to each of the same two-mode reduced states. This compares the phase-optimized Duan test with a general covariance witness for the same bipartition.

Figure 2 shows that the general optimization gives witness values close to the phase-optimized Duan values in Fig. 1. Thus, for these configurations, phase optimization captures much of the available two-mode certification. This comparison concerns witness violations rather than a quantitative measure of entanglement.

C. Entanglement across multimode bipartitions

Now we turn to more parties. We set $l_0 = 2$ and $l_2 = 1$, so that $l_1 = 2l_0 - l_2 = 3$ and $p_{max} = \min(2|l_0|, |l_2|) = 1$. Furthermore, we define the modes as $\mathcal{A} = LG_{0,1}(w_2 = w)$, $\mathcal{B}_0 = LG_{0,3}(w_1)$, $\mathcal{B}_1 = LG_{1,3}(w_1)$ and $\mathcal{C} = LG_{2,3}(w_1)$. Thus $\mathcal{C}$ is a radial mode outside the first-order support for coupling to $\mathcal{A}$. The short-distance calculation certifies the pairs $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{B}_0$ and $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{B}_1$, while it is inconclusive for $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{C}$. By Sec. V B, these two pairs already certify six of the seven bipartitions; the remaining cut is $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{B}_1|\mathcal{C}$. In Fig. 3 we apply FullyWit to the reduced covariance matrix of these four modes and optimize a witness separately for each bipartition. The numerical curves form three groups

- $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_1\mathcal{C}|\mathcal{B}_0$, $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_1|\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{C}$, $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{C}|\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{B}_1$ and $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{B}_1\mathcal{C}$ show the lowest witness values and hence the largest margins below the separability threshold. These share the fact that $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}_0$ belong to different parties, giving a stronger second-moment entanglement certification across these partitions.

- $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{C}|\mathcal{B}_1$ and $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_0|\mathcal{B}_1\mathcal{C}$ show intermediate witness values, still maintaining a linear start. Here the entangled pair $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{B}_1$ crosses the cut, while $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}_0$ belong to the same party.

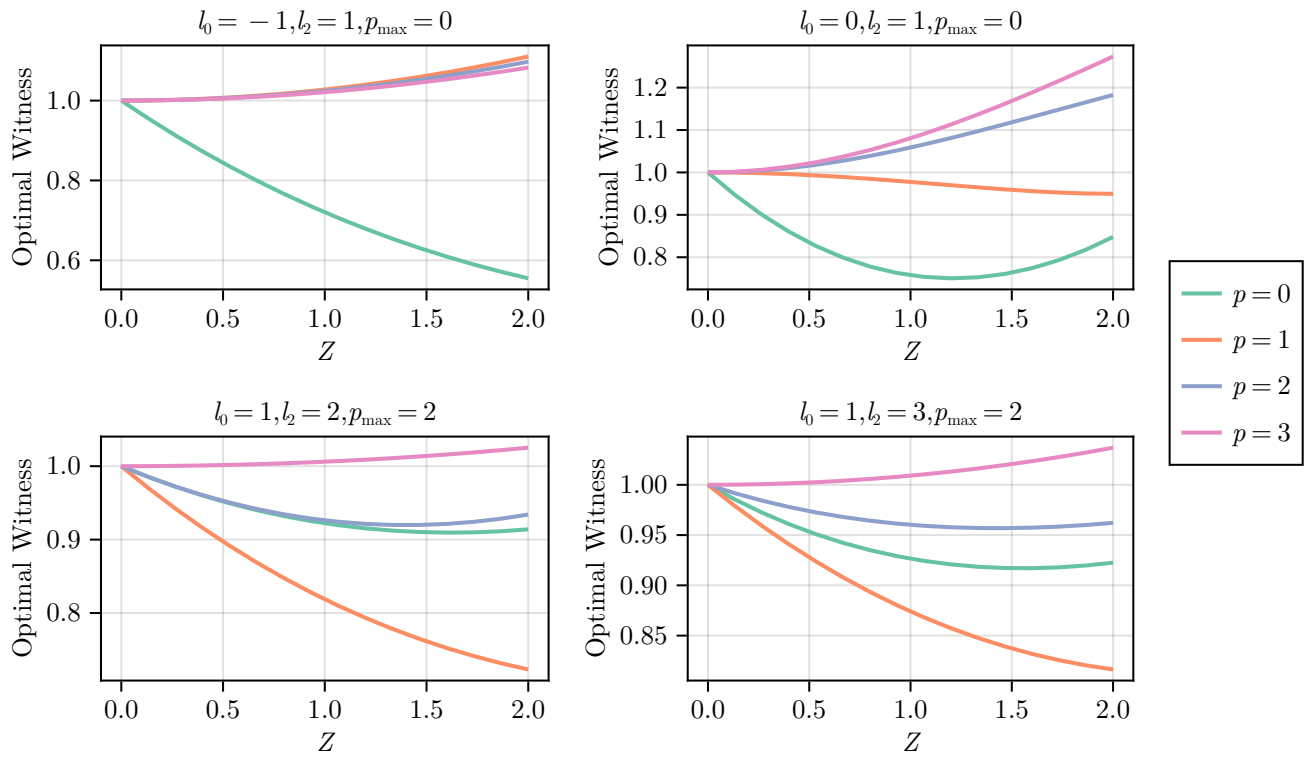


FIG. 2. Optimized covariance witness for the same reduced two-mode states as in Fig. 1. Values below one certify entanglement across the two-mode bipartition.

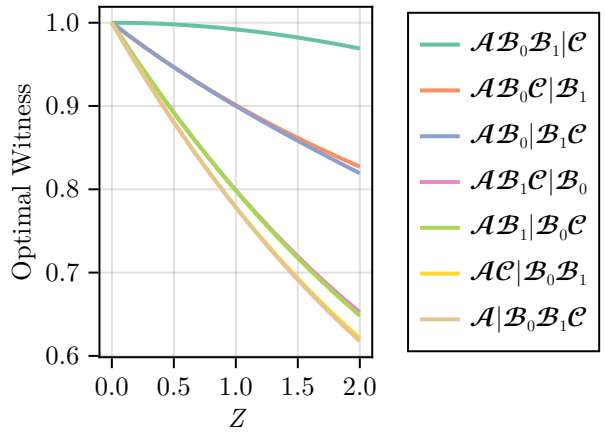


FIG. 3. Optimized covariance witnesses for the seven bipartitions of the reduced four-mode state $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{B}_1\mathcal{C}$. Values below one certify entanglement across the corresponding cut. Here $l_0 = 2$ and $l_2 = 1$, so that $l_1 = 2l_0 - l_2 = 3$ and $p_{max} = \min(2|l_0|, |l_2|) = 1$.

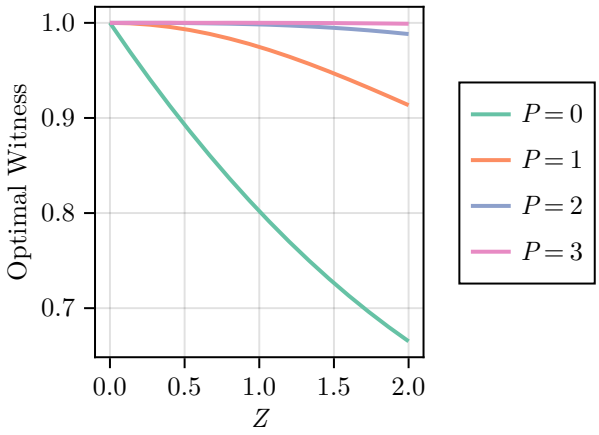


FIG. 4. Optimized witnesses for the reduced selected sets containing $\mathcal{A}$ and radial partners $0 \le p \le P$. Values below one certify bipartite entanglement for $P = 0$ and genuine multipartite entanglement for $P \ge 1$. Here $l_0 = 2$ and $l_2 = 1$, so that $l_1 = 2l_0 - l_2 = 3$ and $p_{max} = \min(2|l_0|, |l_2|) = 1$.

- $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{B}_1|\mathcal{C}$ shows the smallest margin below the separability threshold, with a numerical onset consistent with a quadratic fall. Here both first-order entangled pairs lie within $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{B}_1$, so the individual-pair argument gives no first-order certificate across this cut.

The crossing-pair argument explains why the first six cuts admit linear violations, but does not predict the op-

timized witness values or their near-degeneracies. The small violation for $\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B}_0\mathcal{B}_1|\mathcal{C}$ illustrates that modes outside the first-order radial support can nevertheless participate in entanglement at finite distance.

D. Genuine multipartite entanglement of selected modes

Finally, we apply the biseparable-class optimization of Sec. III D to the reduced selected modes. Unlike testing each cut separately, a MultiWit violation excludes all mixtures in Eq. (18) and therefore certifies GME after the remaining field has been discarded.

In Fig. 4, we show the witness for sets of the form $\{LG_{0,1}(w_2 = w)\} \cup \{LG_{p,3}(w_1) \mid p \leq P\}$, with P varying from 0 to 3, while maintaining $l_0 = 2$. The $P = 0$ case is bipartite; for $P \geq 1$, a violation certifies genuine multipartite entanglement. The numerical results display a pattern related to the first-order radial support: the sets with $P \leq p_{\max} = 1$ have lower witness values and hence larger margins below the separability threshold.

In particular, for $P = 1$ Eq. (49) certifies the pure-state grouping $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{B}_0|(\mathcal{B}_1\mathcal{R})$, whereas a MultiWit violation certifies the reduced three-mode state on $\mathcal{A}|\mathcal{B}_0|\mathcal{B}_1$. The latter shows that genuine multipartite entanglement survives discarding the remaining field modes. Violations for larger selected sets, when present, involve modes outside the first-order support and are finite-distance results within the Bogoliubov approximation.

VII. CONCLUSION

We have derived a chiral selection rule for the first-order anomalous correlations generated by self-phase modulation of a coherent OAM beam. At specified detection waists, radial–angular coupling fixes a finite set of partner modes with nonzero linear Duan violations. These violations guarantee pairwise entanglement and full inseparability of the selected set at sufficiently short nonzero distances. For the full pure field, assigning the remaining modes to one selected party also gives a multipartite grouping whose entanglement follows from the same correlations.

Finite-distance calculations within the diffraction-free Bogoliubov approximation show that the first-order support remains useful for organizing entanglement certification. In the configurations investigated, optimized witnesses reveal weaker violations involving modes outside that support, so it is not an exact finite-distance entanglement boundary. Witnesses valid for all biseparable states additionally certify GME in reduced sets of detection modes. These conclusions concern the certification margins of the chosen criteria and do not quantify the amount of entanglement.

The results identify OAM and the detection profiles as controls over the radial mode combinations that admit covariance-based entanglement certification. They can be investigated in four-wave mixing and self-phase modulation settings where diffraction over the interaction region and fluctuation backreaction are sufficiently small. These findings can be useful to quantum information protocols that require control over multipartite entanglement.

Appendix A: Diffraction-free Bogoliubov evolution

The first-order calculation in the main text retains diffraction and all nonlinear fluctuation terms in Eq. (30). Here we start from the same full fluctuation equation and adopt a different approximation: we neglect diffraction over the interaction region and discard the quadratic and cubic fluctuation terms Ω of Eq. (31), while retaining the full dependence on propagation distance. The resulting Bogoliubov equations are solved without expanding in the propagation distance or the accumulated classical nonlinear phase.

With the same decomposition $\mathcal{E} = \alpha_c + \eta$ and input $\alpha(\mathbf{r}) = \alpha_c(\mathbf{r}, 0)$, these equations are

$$\begin{aligned} 2ik\partial_z \alpha_c &= g|\alpha_c|^2 \alpha_c, \\ 2ik\partial_z \eta &= g\left(2|\alpha_c|^2 \eta + \alpha_c^2 \eta^\dagger\right). \end{aligned} \tag{A1}$$

The classical intensity is constant along propagation. Defining

$$I(\mathbf{r}) = |\alpha(\mathbf{r})|^2, \qquad \theta(\mathbf{r}, z) = \frac{gz}{2k} I(\mathbf{r}), \tag{A2}$$

we have

$$\alpha_c(\mathbf{r}, z) = \alpha(\mathbf{r}) e^{-i\theta(\mathbf{r},z)}. \tag{A3}$$

1. Local fluctuation solution

Each transverse position evolves independently. Introduce the rotating-frame fluctuation $b(\mathbf{r}, z) = e^{i\theta(\mathbf{r},z)}\eta(\mathbf{r}, z)$. Suppressing the position argument temporarily, Eq. (A1) becomes

$$2ik\partial_z b = g\left(Ib + \alpha^2 b^\dagger\right). \tag{A4}$$

Together with its conjugate, this gives

$$2ik\partial_z \begin{pmatrix} b \\ b^\dagger \end{pmatrix} = gM \begin{pmatrix} b \\ b^\dagger \end{pmatrix}, \qquad M = \begin{pmatrix} I & \alpha^2 \\ -\alpha^{*2} & -I \end{pmatrix}. \tag{A5}$$

The matrix is independent of z and satisfies $M^2 = 0$. Therefore its exponential terminates exactly:

$$\exp\left(-\frac{igz}{2k} M\right) = \mathbb{I} - \frac{igz}{2k} M. \tag{A6}$$

Returning to η and writing $\eta_0(\mathbf{r}) = \eta(\mathbf{r}, 0)$, we obtain

$$\eta(\mathbf{r}, z) = e^{-i\theta}\Big[(1 - i\theta)\eta_0(\mathbf{r}) - i\frac{gz}{2k}\alpha^2(\mathbf{r})\eta_0^\dagger(\mathbf{r})\Big]. \tag{A7}$$

Although the rotating-frame coefficients are linear in z, this is not a first-order Taylor approximation. It is the exact solution of the diffraction-free linearized fluctuation equations.

Writing $\eta = A\eta_0 + B\eta_0^\dagger$, the coefficients are

$$A = e^{-i\theta}(1 - i\theta), \qquad B = -i\frac{gz}{2k}\alpha^2 e^{-i\theta}. \tag{A8}$$

They obey $|A|^2 - |B|^2 = 1$, so the field commutator is preserved. For the coherent input, $\langle\eta_0\rangle = 0$ and hence $\langle\eta(z)\rangle = 0$. Thus the mean field equals α_c within this approximation.

2. Field and mode correlations

The initial fluctuations satisfy

$$\begin{aligned}\langle\eta_0(\mathbf{r}_1)\eta_0^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2)\rangle &= \delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2),\\ \langle\eta_0^\dagger(\mathbf{r}_2)\eta_0(\mathbf{r}_1)\rangle &= \langle\eta_0(\mathbf{r}_1)\eta_0(\mathbf{r}_2)\rangle = 0.\end{aligned} \tag{A9}$$

Consequently the correlations are

$$\begin{aligned}F(\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2; z) &= A(\mathbf{r}_1)B(\mathbf{r}_2)\delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2),\\ H(\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2; z) &= B(\mathbf{r}_1)B^*(\mathbf{r}_2)\delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2).\end{aligned} \tag{A10}$$

Substituting the coefficients gives

$$\begin{aligned}F(\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2; z) = &\left[-\frac{igz}{2k} - \left(\frac{gz}{2k}\right)^2 I(\mathbf{r}_1)\right]\\ &\times \alpha_c^2(\mathbf{r}_1, z)\delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2),\\ H(\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2; z) = &\left(\frac{gz}{2k}\right)^2 I^2(\mathbf{r}_1)\delta^{(2)}(\mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2).\end{aligned} \tag{A11}$$

Using the main-text scaling, $\theta = Z|u|^2$ and $u_Z = u\exp(-iZ|u|^2)$, projection onto the detection modes yields

$$\begin{aligned}f(v_1, v_2) = &-iZ(v_1, v_2; u_Z, u_Z)\\ &- Z^2(v_1, v_2, u_Z; u_Z, u_Z, u_Z),\\ h(v_1, v_2) = &\, Z^2(v_1, u_Z, u_Z; v_2, u_Z, u_Z).\end{aligned} \tag{A12}$$

The phases in h cancel, whereas those in f retain the nonlinear classical evolution. Expanding Eq. (A12) at small Z recovers $f = -iZ(v_1, v_2; u, u) + \mathcal{O}(Z^2)$ and $h = \mathcal{O}(Z^2)$, in agreement with the first-order calculation in the main text. At finite distance, these expressions are exact only within the diffraction-free Bogoliubov approximation, not for the full quantum Kerr equation.

The approximation requires negligible diffraction of the relevant transverse structures over the interaction length, as well as sufficiently small fluctuation interactions and backreaction on the classical field. A large pump Rayleigh range is a useful initial scale, but finer structure generated by the nonlinear phase can have shorter diffraction lengths. The derivation applies to any coherent input profile, including a coherent pump plus seeds.

The Bogoliubov approximation also permits retaining diffraction in both the classical background and the linear fluctuation equations. Quantum correlations can then be computed numerically by propagating the corresponding Green functions [44, 45], or by back-propagating the detection functions with the adjoint fluctuation equations [46, 47] and evaluating their correlations in the known input state. Such a numerical treatment with diffraction lies beyond the scope of the present work, which uses the analytical diffraction-free solution above.

Appendix B: Coherent seeding and first-order selection rules

1. Role of the seed in quadrature detection

For the single coherent pump $\alpha = A_p v_p$, with $v_p = LG_{0,l_p}(w)$, both terms in Eq. (B3) with $\epsilon = 0$ vanish for a detection mode of definite OAM $l_v \neq l_p$: the nonlinear mean-field source $|v_p|^2 v_p$ carries the same OAM as the pump. Thus, within this first-order treatment, self-phase modulation changes the mean field only in the $l = l_p$ sector, including its radial structure.

The two-mode correlations studied in the main text instead involve $l_1 + l_2 = 2l_p$ with $l_2 \neq l_p$, so neither detected mode has a coherent mean at this order. This does not prevent quadrature measurements with an external local oscillator, but a coherent amplitude in a detected mode can assist spatial alignment and phase control. The purpose of the seed is to supply such a reference while retaining, as closely as possible, the original entanglement correlations. Zero coherent mean should not be identified with exactly zero photon occupation: the centered population $h(v, v)$ starts beyond first order in distance.

We consider mutually coherent, collinear pump and seed fields sharing the frequency, polarization, and temporal mode implicit in our scalar model. We first derive the first-order correlations for an arbitrary spatial seed, and then examine seeding only v_2 or directly seeding both detected OAM families. Throughout this appendix, "first order" in propagation refers to the coefficient linear in distance; terms linear and quadratic in seed amplitude are distinguished explicitly.

2. First-order corrections for an arbitrary coherent seed

Let the input profile be

$$\alpha(\mathbf{r},0) = A_p\big[v_p(\mathbf{r}) + \epsilon s(\mathbf{r})\big], \tag{B1}$$

where $\|v_p\| = \|s\| = 1$ and the complex parameter ϵ specifies the overall seed amplitude and phase relative to the pump. The normalized profile s specifies its spatial composition; for example, $s = \sum_j c_j v_{s,j}$ in an orthonormal seed basis, with $\sum_j |c_j|^2 = 1$. We use the pump waist and occupation $N_p = A_p^2$ to define

$$\begin{aligned} U_p &= w v_p, \\ S &= w s, \\ U &= U_p + \epsilon S, \\ Z_p &= \frac{g z N_p}{2kw^2}. \end{aligned} \tag{B2}$$

The profiles U_p, S, U are dimensionless, and Z_p is held fixed when comparing different seeds. Weak seeding means $|\epsilon| \ll 1$; it need not imply a seed occupation smaller than one. If the seed is orthogonal to the pump, its occupation relative to the pump is $q = |\epsilon|^2$, and the main-text normalization is $u = U/\sqrt{1+q}$, $Z = (1+q)Z_p$. More generally, replace $1+q$ by $\|v_p + \epsilon s\|^2$. These conventions give the same product $Zu^2 = Z_p U^2$.

The input remains a coherent state of a spatial field distribution. Therefore, the mean-field formula and the general correlation derivation apply directly to the combined profile. For example, in freely propagated detection modes, with the nonlinear overlap evaluated at the input plane,

$$\langle a(v,z)\rangle = \frac{A_p}{w}\left[(v,U) - iZ_p(v,U;U,U)\right] + O(Z_p^2). \tag{B3}$$

For orthonormal detection modes v_1, v_2, define

$$\begin{aligned} C_{12} &= (v_1, v_2; U_p, U_p), \\ \delta C_{12}^{(1)} &= 2\epsilon(v_1, v_2; U_p, S), \\ \delta C_{12}^{(2)} &= \epsilon^2(v_1, v_2; S, S). \end{aligned} \tag{B4}$$

The superscripts indicate order in seed amplitude, not distance. Expanding $U^2 = (U_p + \epsilon S)^2$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} f(v_1,v_2) &= -iZ_p\left[C_{12} + \delta C_{12}^{(1)} + \delta C_{12}^{(2)}\right] + O(Z_p^2), \\ h(v_1,v_2) &= O(Z_p^2), \\ D_{\rm opt} &= 1 - 2|Z_p|\left|C_{12} + \delta C_{12}^{(1)} + \delta C_{12}^{(2)}\right| + O(Z_p^2). \end{aligned} \tag{B5}$$

This is the complete coefficient linear in distance for an arbitrary coherent seed. It contains no terms beyond quadratic order in seed amplitude. Because f and h are centered correlations, the seed's coherent displacement alone does not contribute to them; the corrections above arise from its participation in the nonlinear interaction.

The angular content determines which corrections survive. Write

$$U_p = R_p(r)e^{il_p\phi}, \qquad S = \sum_m S_m(r)e^{im\phi}. \tag{B6}$$

For detection OAM sum $L = l_1 + l_2$, the pump–seed term requires $l_p + m = L$, and the seed–seed term requires $m + n = L$. In the original channel $L = 2l_p$, the relevant harmonic is

$$[U^2]_{2l_p} = e^{2il_p\phi}\left[R_p^2 + 2\epsilon R_p S_{l_p} + \epsilon^2 \sum_m S_m S_{2l_p - m}\right]. \tag{B7}$$

Thus only a seed component with pump OAM can modify this channel linearly in seed amplitude. Quadratic corrections require complementary seed OAM values summing to $2l_p$. The radial overlaps must also be nonzero. In particular, a seed with pump OAM but a different radial profile can alter the radial rule at linear order in seed amplitude; a seed proportional to v_p simply changes the combined pump amplitude.

3. Seeding only the mode v_2

Consider the same detection family as in the main text,

$$\begin{aligned} v_p &= LG_{0,l_p}(w), \\ v_2 &= LG_{0,l_2}(w_2), \\ v_{1,p} &= LG_{p,l_1}(w_1), \\ l_1 &= 2l_p - l_2, \\ \frac{1}{w_1^2} &= \frac{2}{w^2} + \frac{1}{w_2^2}, \qquad l_2 \neq l_p. \end{aligned} \tag{B8}$$

Here l_p denotes pump OAM, whereas the index p of $v_{1,p}$ denotes radial order. Set $s = v_2$, so $S = U_2$, where $U_2 = wv_2$. The pump–seed and seed–seed terms carry OAM $l_p + l_2$ and $2l_2$, respectively. Neither equals $2l_p$, so both corrections vanish in the original channel. Defining $C_p = (v_{1,p}, v_2; U_p, U_p)$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} f(v_{1,p}, v_2) &= -iZ_p C_p + O(Z_p^2), \\ D_{\rm opt} &= 1 - 2|Z_p C_p| + O(Z_p^2). \end{aligned} \tag{B9}$$

The coefficient linear in distance is independent of ϵ, including its phase. Hence the original cutoff

$$p_{\max} = |l_p| + \frac{|l_2| - |2l_p - l_2|}{2} \tag{B10}$$

is preserved exactly at this order for the detection profiles in (B8): $C_p = 0$ for $p > p_{\max}$. The seed does open other OAM channels, at orders $Z_p\epsilon$ and $Z_p\epsilon^2$, but these do not enter the selected pair's first-order coefficient.

The mean-field benefit is twofold. The seeded mode has the input amplitude

$$\langle a(v_2,0)\rangle = A_p\epsilon. \tag{B11}$$

Moreover, the nonlinear source $|U|^2U$ contains $\epsilon^* U_p^2 U_2^*$, whose OAM is $2l_p - l_2 = l_1$. Projection of (B3) therefore yields

$$\langle a(v_{1,p},z)\rangle = -iZ_pA_p\epsilon^* C_p + O(Z_p^2). \tag{B12}$$

A seed in v_2 can thus generate coherent references in its conjugate radial modes while preserving the original first-order correlations. These stimulated amplitudes are suppressed by Z_p, follow the radial coefficients C_p, and vanish at this order outside the cutoff. Whether they suffice for homodyne phase control depends on the experimental sensitivity.

4. Seeding both detected OAM families

To supply a direct coherent reference in every selected detection mode, including radial modes whose stimulated amplitudes are too small, take

$$S = c_2U_2 + \sum_{p\in\mathcal{S}} c_{1,p}U_{1,p}, \tag{B13}$$

where $U_{1,p} = wv_{1,p}$ and $\mathcal{S}$ is the finite set of seeded radial orders. The two OAM families and the pump are mutually orthogonal, as are the radial modes within the first family. Normalization of s requires

$$|c_2|^2 + \sum_{p\in\mathcal{S}} |c_{1,p}|^2 = 1, \tag{B14}$$

the seed power fraction is $q = |\epsilon|^2$, and the input means are $\langle a(v_2,0)\rangle = A_p\epsilon c_2$ and $\langle a(v_{1,p},0)\rangle = A_p\epsilon c_{1,p}$. These directly injected amplitudes are not suppressed by propagation distance.

Neither seed family has pump OAM, so $\delta C^{(1)}$ still vanishes in the original channel. However, their OAM values are complementary: $l_1 + l_2 = 2l_p$. Equation (B7) now gives

$$[U^2]_{2l_p} = U_p^2 + 2\epsilon^2 c_2 \sum_{p\in\mathcal{S}} c_{1,p}U_2U_{1,p}. \tag{B15}$$

For a detected radial order r, define

$$\begin{aligned} K_{rp} &= (v_{1,r}, v_2; U_2, U_{1,p}) \\ &= w^2 \int d^2\mathbf{r}\, v_{1,r}^* v_{1,p} |v_2|^2, \\ \delta C_r &= 2\epsilon^2 c_2 \sum_{p\in\mathcal{S}} c_{1,p} K_{rp}. \end{aligned} \tag{B16}$$

The first-order correlations become

$$\begin{aligned} f(v_{1,r}, v_2) &= -iZ_p(C_r + \delta C_r) + O(Z_p^2), \\ D_{\text{opt}} &= 1 - 2|Z_p|\,|C_r + \delta C_r| + O(Z_p^2). \end{aligned} \tag{B17}$$

The correction is quadratic in seed amplitudes but remains linear in distance. Its phase relative to C_r depends on the products $\epsilon^2 c_2 c_{1,p}$, so complementary seeds can enhance or reduce the magnitude of an allowed correlation.

The weighted overlaps K_{rp} need not obey the original radial cutoff. Orthogonality of radial LG modes uses an unweighted inner product, whereas the factor $|v_2|^2$ changes the radial weight and Gaussian envelope. In particular,

$$K_{rr} = w^2 \int d^2\mathbf{r}\, |v_{1,r}|^2 |v_2|^2 > 0 \tag{B18}$$

for overlapping LG profiles. Thus directly seeding $v_{1,r}$ and v_2 can remove a first-order zero even when $r > p_{\max}$ and $C_r = 0$. Multiple radial seeds may interfere, with cancellation possible only for particular amplitudes and phases.

For a fixed normalized seed profile, $\delta C_r = O(\epsilon^2)$ and $q = |\epsilon|^2$. The original radial rule is therefore preserved through linear order in seed amplitude, but generally modified at quadratic order in seed amplitude, or first order in seed power fraction at fixed seed composition. For an allowed pair, the condition

$$|\delta C_r| \ll |C_r| \tag{B19}$$

ensures that its first-order correlation is approximately unchanged. For a forbidden pair, any nonzero δC_r lifts the first-order zero, however small its absolute magnitude.

Seeding only v_2 therefore preserves the original first-order radial rule exactly while relying on stimulated means in the complementary family. Seeding both families supplies independent input references in all selected modes, at the cost of quadratic seed corrections to that rule. These statements concern the first-order two-mode criterion; they do not establish a multipartite selection rule or a finite-distance witness violation. Beyond the small-distance regime, the combined input may be inserted directly into the correlation formulas of Appendix A, within their stated assumptions.

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